

Subject: Re: [Town Meeting] Check and fix attendance statistics
From: Susan Doctrow <srdoctrow@gmail.com>
Date: 5/14/12, 14:50
To: Stephen Harrington <sth.alist@gmail.com>
CC: townmeeting@arlingtonlist.org

Dear Colleagues,

In the spirit of not using this list (any longer) for discussions but, instead, for reports to also be distributed at TM, I have sent my response to Mr. Harrington off-list.

However, briefly, I do want to say that I regret any perception that my post insulted Mr. Harrington's effort to provide TM attendance summaries, because that was not my intent. I agree that it is potentially useful information to have, though it's also important to know as much as possible about how any such summary data are generated.

Sue Doctrow
Pct 21

On May 14, 2012, at 1:01 PM, Stephen Harrington wrote:

Hi Dr. Doctrow,

I always love when someone writes or says, "I know I shouldn't do this, but I'm going to anyways" and coupled to the desire to correct someone publicly, reminds me of my days on the Arlington List!

Anyways, since we are nitpicking, you are wrong as well. Mike Malone was a Town Meeting Member in Precinct 21 who resigned just prior to the meeting. Technically, he was not a "vacancy", certainly not on the order of a vacancy that was available at election time. Therefore, it is my call to include his absences as part of the possible attendances for precinct 21 giving you guys only an 86% attendance rate.

Must feel bad to represent a precinct with a less than stellar public service commitment.

I caught the mistakes that you so generously forgave of the clerk's office in their totals for precincts 8, 19, 20 and 21 and even corrected for vacancies (for real and of the Malone-type) in the "By Date" table, so I feel pretty good about doing something positive. I also, against the desire of some co-contributors, did not include a "Hall of Shame" for those who never show because of sense of civility and compassion for those ill (terminally or otherwise) even though some argued the Costas in precinct 4 needed to be "outed".

But I don't feel the need to pass judgement publicly on people.

Perhaps, you could have contributed by a private note, but I understand the desire to chip away instead of build-up.

Best,

Mr. Harrington

On Mon, May 14, 2012 at 12:09 PM, Susan Doctrow <srdoctrow@gmail.com> wrote:

I realize I'm sending a "discussion point" so it probably shouldn't be sent on this email list..but it is a simple point. Noting patterns of attendance at TM is of value (though I'd like to see after the break captured somehow!), but I hope Mr. Harrington and others will check and correct the numbers he just sent. Precinct 21 stats are incorrect on his chart. Our "possibles" was 54 because we had two vacancies until May 2. Our percentage, therefore, is 91, not 82%. Potentially, others are wrong, too.

(Also, unless I'm misunderstanding it, the totals column on the Town website has a problem on some pages...Pct 19, 20 and 21 have totals of "4" for people who were present at all 5 sessions..no doubt just a formula pasting oversight; I will send a message to the Clerk's office.)

http://www.arlingtonma.gov/public_documents/arlingtonma_townmeet/2012ATM/voting/Attendance_for_2012_Town_Meeting.pdf

Sue Doctrow
Precinct 21

On May 14, 2012, at 7:53 AM, Stephen Harrington wrote:

Dear Town Meeting Members,

Attached is an overview of Town Meeting attendance that you might find informative. Enjoy!

Stephen Harrington
Precinct 13

<TM Attendance.pdf> _____
townmeeting mailing list
townmeeting@arlingtonlist.org

<http://seven.pairlist.net/mailman/listinfo/townmeeting>